

South Downs Beef Information Pack

Introduction

Chef's Farms has partnered with Luke at Waterlands Farm to build a bespoke and entirely traceable local beef supply chain. Luke is unique in that he also owns a small abattoir, giving him total control over the full life cycle of his animals. We are incredibly fortunate to have access to this product.

Farm Information

Luke farms cows, sheep and goats in carefully managed small groups across the South Downs. He runs a low input, extensive system, meaning he stocks his land below its natural carrying capacity, i.e. everything the animals need to eat all year round is grown on the farm, no feed is brought in. He also does not use any synthetic chemical inputs on his land. This is fantastic for many reasons, but one especially relevant one now is that Luke's farm is isolated from the rising fertilizer prices caused by the closing of the strait of Hormuz.

The cattle are split into calving groups which rotate across the farm, followed by the sheep, in a system known as rotational grazing. This gives the grass time to recover and grow back stronger, fertilized naturally by the animals.

Product

Luke's herd are a blend of Belted Galloway and Blue Gray cows. Two hardy breeds that suit his system well. The cows are killed at Luke's own abattoir, hung and butchered to order, guaranteeing traceability on all products.

